

USER MANUAL

WinGOES Pro

Professional Windows Rebuild & Migration Assistant

Rebuild Windows cleanly. Restore only what matters.

STEP 1
CAPTURE

STEP 2
APPLY

STEP 3
VERIFY

Version 2.1 · Document Rev. 3

Windows 10 / 11 · Python 3.11+ · PyQt6

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TIP

In a hurry? Read **Chapter 4 — The Step-by-Step Walkthrough**. It takes you from nothing to a fully rebuilt PC in six steps. Everything else is reference material you can come back to.

About this manual

This manual covers **WinGOES Pro 2.1** on Windows 10 and Windows 11. It assumes no prior knowledge of the tool. Anything you must type is shown in teal monospace; names of buttons and menus are in bold.

Symbol	Meaning
TIP	A shortcut or helpful suggestion.
WARNING	Read this before continuing; a mistake here could cost you time or data.
DANGER	Something you should not do.

1 Welcome to WinGOES Pro

What it does, what it never does, and how it works in one picture.

WinGOES Pro is a guided assistant that helps you rebuild Windows without dragging old problems along with it. A clean Windows install is usually the best fix for a slow, cluttered, or unstable PC. The painful part has always been remembering everything you had installed and configured. WinGOES Pro takes care of that part.

It follows one simple idea: **capture your useful setup, install Windows fresh, then restore only what is safe.**

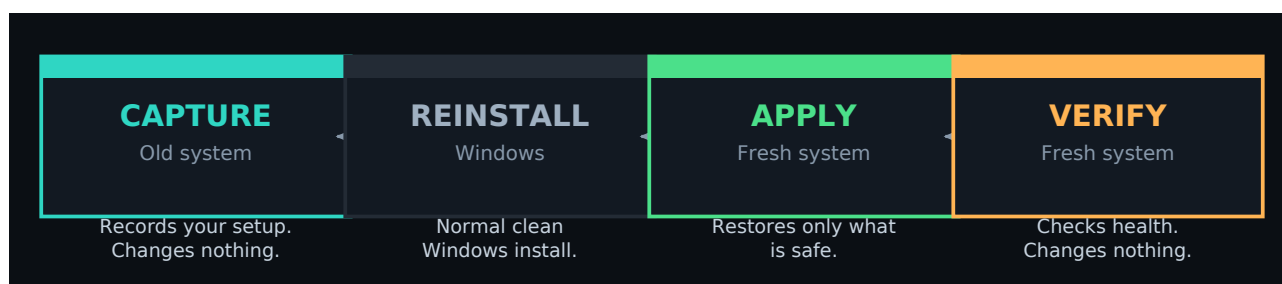


Figure 1 — The WinGOES Pro workflow. You can run each stage on a different day, or on a different PC.

What WinGOES Pro saves and restores

Category	What's included
Apps	Everything installed through Winget , Chocolatey and Scoop , plus a full installed-applications inventory for reference.
Developer settings	Git configuration and .gitconfig, SSH keys, VS Code (extensions, settings, keybindings), Windows Terminal profiles.
Windows settings	Timezone/region and power plan only (a small, safe allowlist). Only available in advanced modes on matching hardware.
Drivers	A driver inventory and an easy post-install checklist. Transferring the DriverStore is an advanced, tightly gated option.

What WinGOES Pro will never do

These actions are blocked by design, **in every mode**. They are the most common causes of long-term Windows instability:

- Import or export raw registry data
- Copy drivers blindly between different hardware
- Clone or image your system disk
- Download files silently from the internet
- Migrate browser passwords or cookies

GOOD TO KNOW

WinGOES Pro is **not** a disk-cloning or “restore everything exactly as it was” tool. That is deliberate: it prioritises stability, clarity and control over convenience shortcuts.

2 Getting Started

Install the requirements, launch the app, and start your free trial.

What you need

Requirement	Details
Windows	Windows 10 or Windows 11
Python & PyQt6	Python 3.11 or newer, plus the PyQt6 package (installed in the steps below)
Optional tools	winget, choco, scoop, git, code. Only needed for the features that use them. For the best look, install the JetBrains Mono font (Cascadia Mono or Consolas is used otherwise).

GOOD TO KNOW

Your 14-day free trial starts automatically the first time you open the app. No registration and no internet connection are needed. See Chapter 7 for activating a license key.

Installation in four steps

1

Install Python 3.11 or newer

Download it from python.org and run the installer. On the first installer screen, tick **“Add python.exe to PATH”** before clicking Install.

2

Install PyQt6

Open **Command Prompt** or **PowerShell** and type:

```
pip install PyQt6
```

3

Unzip WinGOES Pro

Extract `wingoes_pro.zip` to a folder you'll remember, for example `C:\WinGOES`. You'll see a `src` folder, a `docs` folder, and a file called `run.bat`.

4

Launch the app

Double-click `run.bat`. A black console window opens briefly and then the WinGOES Pro window appears.

Or, from inside the `src` folder, run:

```
python gui_app.py
```

TIP

Run as administrator for best results. Right-click `run.bat` and choose **Run as administrator**. Driver features need it. The sidebar badge shows ✓ **Admin** (green) when elevated, or ⚠ **Admin** (amber) when not.

3 Meet the Main Window

A guided tour of every control, from top to bottom.

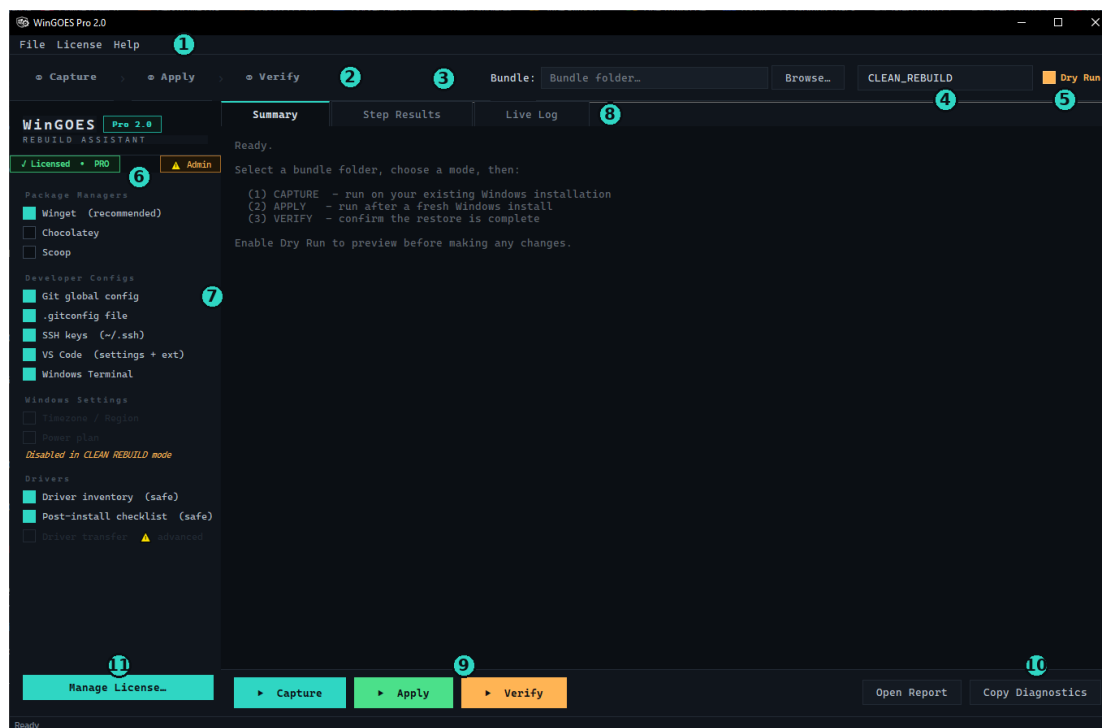


Figure 2 — The WinGOES Pro main window (screenshot from a 2.0 build). Numbers match the table below.

#	Control	What it does
1	Menu bar	File: Select Bundle Folder, Open Last Report, Exit. License: Manage License. Help: How to Use, About.
2	Workflow strip	Shows ① Capture > ② Apply > ③ Verify . The running stage is underlined in teal.
3	Bundle	The folder where everything is saved. Click Browse... to choose it.
4	Mode selector	CLEAN_REBUILD (default), SAME_Hardware_TRANSFER or CUSTOM.
5	Dry Run switch	Amber safety switch, ON by default . When on, nothing is changed; every action is only previewed.
6	License & Admin badges	License state (green = licensed, amber = trial) and whether you are running as administrator.
7	Feature toggles	Tick what you want to keep. Options the current mode forbids are greyed out, with an amber note explaining why.
8	Output tabs	Summary (the story of the run), Step Results (item-by-item table), Live Log (raw, timestamped log).
9	Action buttons	► Capture (teal), ► Apply (green), ► Verify (amber).
10	Open Report / Copy Diagnostics	Open the last run's report .json, or copy the report and summary paths to the clipboard for support.
11	Manage License...	Opens the activation dialog. The status bar at the very bottom shows progress and the last result.

4 The Step-by-Step Walkthrough

Six steps from your old Windows to a fully rebuilt PC.

WARNING

Before you begin: have a USB drive or external disk ready for the bundle, plus a second place for a backup copy. The bundle is the only thing carrying your setup across the reinstall.

PART A — On your existing Windows (before reinstalling)

1

Choose the right mode

Use the **mode selector** in the top toolbar. Not sure which to pick? Follow the chart below, or simply choose **CLEAN_REBUILD**. It is the default, always safe, and right for almost everyone.

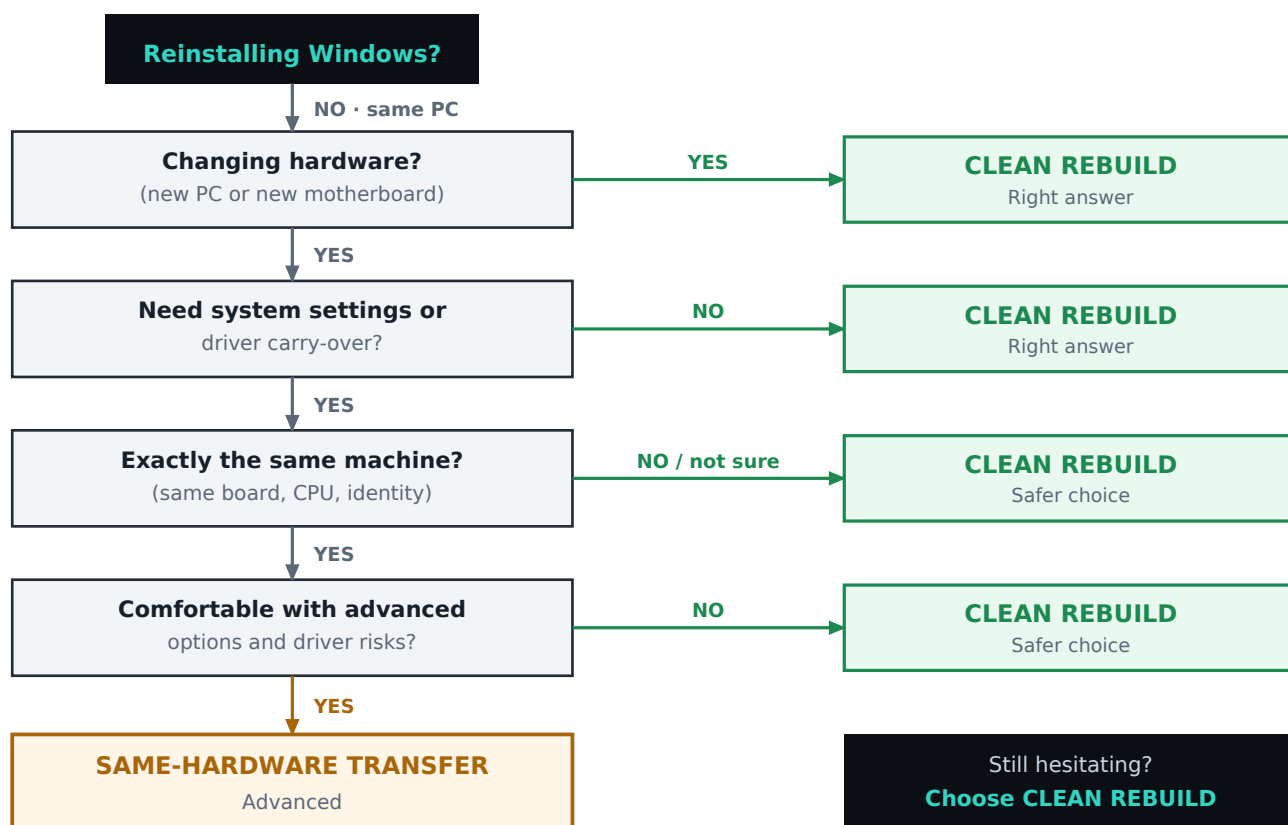


Figure 3 — Mode selection flowchart.

Mode	Choose it when	Safety
CLEAN REBUILD (default)	New PC, fresh install, or you simply want to leave old problems behind.	Safest. Risky transfers blocked.
SAME-HARDWARE TRANSFER	Reinstalling on the exact same physical PC and you want the gated extras.	Advanced. Needs hardware PASS.
CUSTOM	You're an expert who wants every toggle under manual control.	Expert. Safety gates still apply.

2

Choose what to keep, and where to save it

Use the **toggles in the sidebar**. Tick only what you actually use. The defaults suit most people:

- **Package Managers:** **Winget** is recommended. Add Chocolatey or Scoop only if you use them.
- **Developer Configs:** Git, .gitconfig, SSH keys, VS Code, Windows Terminal.
- **Drivers:** leave **Driver inventory** and **Post-install checklist** on. Both are safe and very useful.

Then click **Browse...** beside **Bundle** and choose (or create) an empty folder, for example D:\MyBundle. Pick a drive that will **not** be wiped when you reinstall Windows.

WARNING

SSH private keys are copied into the bundle exactly as they are. Treat the bundle folder with the same care as the keys themselves. Don't leave it on a shared drive or an unencrypted USB stick you might lose.

3

Run CAPTURE

1. Leave **Dry Run** ON for a first look at what would be saved. Capture only reads your system, so it is safe either way.
2. Click the teal ► **Capture** button.
3. Watch the **Live Log**. When it finishes, the **Summary** tab shows a completion badge and **Step Results** lists every item.
4. Switch **Dry Run** OFF and run Capture once more, so the bundle holds your real data rather than a preview.
5. Copy the whole bundle folder to a USB drive or external disk, and keep a second copy elsewhere.

GOOD TO KNOW

Nothing on your system is changed by Capture. You can run it as many times as you like; each run is journalled separately.

PART B — Reinstall Windows

4

Install Windows cleanly

Perform a normal Windows 10 or 11 clean install and finish the initial setup. **Do not** copy old system folders or drivers across by hand; that is exactly what WinGOES Pro helps you avoid.

Then install **Python 3.11+**, run `pip install PyQt6` again (see Chapter 2), and copy WinGOES Pro and your **bundle folder** onto the new system.

PART C — On your fresh Windows

5

Run APPLY: preview first, then for real

Preview (strongly recommended)

1. Launch WinGOES Pro (as administrator if possible) and click **Browse...** to select your bundle folder.
2. Select the **same mode** you used during Capture.
3. Leave **Dry Run ON** and click the green ► **Apply** button.
4. Open **Step Results** and read it. This is exactly what a real run will do.

Apply for real

1. Switch **Dry Run OFF** (the amber switch) and click ► **Apply** again.
2. A dialog warns “*Dry Run is OFF. This will make real changes to the system.*” Click **Proceed**.
3. Wait for the ✓ **COMPLETED** badge in Summary.

GOOD TO KNOW

Apply **backs up any existing config file with a timestamp** before replacing it, and automatically skips anything that needs a hardware match you don't have.

6

Run VERIFY and finish the checklist

1. Click the amber ► **Verify** button.
2. Read the **completion checklist** in Summary. It typically covers the GPU driver, chipset package and any vendor tools you install by hand.
3. Work through it to the end.

Verify never modifies your system and can be re-run any time.

TIP

Congratulations, you're done. You now have a clean Windows install with your useful setup restored and your old problems left behind.

5

Feature Toggles Reference

What every checkbox in the sidebar does.

Package Managers

Toggle	Captures	Applies / notes
Winget (recommended)	Exported package list	Reinstalls where available. Games, vendor installers and Store apps may not auto-reinstall; they are recorded, not forced.
Chocolatey	choco list output	Reinstalls via choco. Enable only if you use it.
Scoop	Scoop export	Reinstalls via scoop. Enable only if you use it.

An **installed-applications inventory** is always captured alongside, as a reference for anything the package managers can't cover.

Developer Configs

Toggle	Captures	Applies
Git global config	<code>git config --global</code> values	Restores your identity and preferences.
.gitconfig file	The raw <code>~/.gitconfig</code>	Restores the file (existing one backed up first).
SSH keys	<code>~/.ssh</code> : keys, known_hosts, config	Restores SSH access for Git, servers and automation.
VS Code	Extensions list, settings, keybindings	Reinstalls extensions, restores preferences.
Windows Terminal	Profiles and appearance	Restores terminal configuration.

Windows Settings (gated)

Timezone/Region and Power plan. A small, safe, reversible allowlist; never arbitrary registry data.

Mode	Timezone / Power plan
CLEAN REBUILD	✗ Disabled by policy
SAME-HARDWARE TRANSFER	✓ Only if the hardware match is PASS
CUSTOM	✓ Only if the hardware match is PASS

Drivers

Toggle	Risk	What it does
Driver inventory	Safe	Records every installed driver for reference.
Post-install checklist	Safe	Builds an “install these manually” list from your hardware fingerprint (chipset, GPU, network hints).
Driver transfer	Advanced	Exports the DriverStore at Capture and restores it at Apply. Only on hardware-match PASS, only outside CLEAN REBUILD, and only if you switch it on.

TIP

When in doubt, use **inventory + checklist** and download drivers fresh from the manufacturer. That's the most reliable route.

How the hardware check works

During Capture, WinGOES Pro records a fingerprint of the machine (manufacturer/model, baseboard, BIOS identity, CPU, GPUs, network adapters). During Apply and Verify it fingerprints the current machine and rates the match. You never configure this; the engine enforces it automatically, even if a toggle was switched on.

Result	Meaning	Effect
PASS	Same board and CPU, overlapping network adapters	Gated features permitted (if enabled)
PARTIAL	Some identity overlap	Gated features disabled
FAIL / UNKNOWN	Different machine, or no source fingerprint	Gated features disabled

6 Understanding the Results

What the colours, badges and log messages mean.

Dry Run

The amber **Dry Run** switch is **ON by default**. While it's on, every action is simulated: reports, summaries and Step Results look exactly as they would in a real run, with each action labelled as simulated, but nothing is changed. Turning it off before an Apply triggers a confirmation dialog.

The completion badge

Badge	Meaning
✓ COMPLETED	Every step finished (or was simulated) successfully.
⚠ COMPLETED WITH ISSUES	Some items need your attention, usually best-effort package installs that need a manual download. Open Step Results , find the red rows and read their Message column.

Step Results colour code

Colour	Meaning
Green · OK	Item completed (or was simulated) successfully.
Red · FAIL	Item did not complete. Read the message.
Grey	Informational or skipped.

GOOD TO KNOW

Warnings are not failures. A message such as *"Installed package is not available from any source"* simply means Winget detected the app but can't reinstall it automatically. Nothing is broken; WinGOES Pro records it so you know what to reinstall by hand. Only entries marked **fatal** indicate a real failure.

7 Licensing & Activation

Free trial, activating a key, and moving a license between PCs.

The 14-day free trial

The trial begins automatically on first launch. No registration and no internet. The sidebar badge shows the days remaining, for example Trial • 12d left in amber. After the trial, a license key is required.

Activating a license

1 Open the license dialog

Choose **License** → **Manage License...**, or click the teal **Manage License...** button at the bottom of the sidebar.

2 Enter your key

Type or paste your key in this format:

```
WGPRO - XXXXX - XXXXX - XXXXX - XXXXX
```

Optionally give the seat a name, such as “Main Dev PC”.

3 Click Activate

The sidebar badge turns green and reads ✓ Licensed • PRO (or HOME / TEAM, depending on your edition).

Keys are checked **locally** using an HMAC-SHA256 signature. There is no call-home and no internet requirement.

Deactivating a license

To use your key on a different PC, open the same dialog while licensed and click **Deactivate License**. This removes the stored license from the machine so the key can be used elsewhere.

Where is my license stored?

In %APPDATA%\WinGOES Pro\. The file is integrity-signed, so editing it by hand invalidates it.

NOTE

Key not accepted? Keys are 25 characters in five groups of five, using letters and digits from the Base32 set (no 0, 1, 8 or 9). The dialog tells you whether the format or the checksum failed, which makes typos easy to spot.

8 Reports & the Bundle Folder

Where everything is stored, and how to find it.

Everything WinGOES Pro captures lives in one folder you choose: the **bundle**. It is made of plain, human-readable files (JSON, text, configs) and is portable across drives and machines. Treat it as the single item to back up between Capture and Apply.

```
my_bundle/
├── fingerprints/    source_ / target_fingerprint.json
├── packages/        winget / choco / scoop exports + app inventory
├── configs/         git, ssh, vscode, terminal, settings
├── drivers/         inventory, checklist, optional DriverStore export
├── runs/
│   └── <run_id>/
│       ├── report.json    full machine-readable result
│       ├── summary.txt    human-readable summary
│       └── run.log        complete timestamped log
```

Every run, dry or real, writes a complete journal under runs/. Click **Open Report** in the action bar, or choose **File → Open Last Report**, to open the most recent report.json. **Copy Diagnostics** copies the report and summary paths to your clipboard, handy when asking for support.

9 Common Scenarios

Pick the one closest to your situation and follow the recipe.

New PC build **CLEAN REBUILD**

Enable Winget, Git, SSH, VS Code and Windows Terminal. Capture on the old machine; Apply and Verify on the new one. You get clean Windows, your dev environment restored and zero legacy baggage.

Same PC, fresh Windows **SAME-HARDWARE TRANSFER**

Enable the extras you want (timezone, power plan). The hardware match unlocks them automatically. Everything else is as above. If you'd rather keep it simple, CLEAN REBUILD works here too.

"I just want a checklist" **CLEAN REBUILD**

Enable only **Driver inventory** and **Post-install checklist**, run Capture, and use the files in drivers/ and packages/ as a manual rebuild reference. You never need to run Apply.

Family PC rescue **CLEAN REBUILD**

Use Winget only. Capture, reinstall Windows, Apply. The post-install checklist tells you which vendor drivers to fetch. Ten minutes of clicking replaced by one bundle.

10 Troubleshooting & FAQ

Quick answers to the most common questions.

Problem	Why it happens	What to do
Some toggles are greyed out	You're in CLEAN REBUILD, or the hardware match wasn't PASS.	This is intended. The amber note under the toggle explains which. Use inventory + checklist instead.
Badge shows  Admin	WinGOES Pro isn't running elevated.	Close it and relaunch with Run as administrator . Driver inventory and DriverStore export work best elevated.
COMPLETED WITH ISSUES after Apply	Best-effort items (usually package installs) couldn't be automated.	Open Step Results , read the red rows, and reinstall those by hand. Real failures say <i>fatal</i> in the log.
"Installed package is not available from any source"	Winget found the app but can't reinstall it.	Normal. Download it manually; it's on your checklist.
License key rejected	Typo, or invalid characters.	Check for 5 groups of 5 characters and no 0, 1, 8 or 9. Read the dialog's message.
The window won't open	Python or PyQt6 isn't installed correctly.	Re-run <code>pip install PyQt6</code> and check <code>python --version</code> shows 3.11 or higher.
Can I use one bundle on several PCs?	—	Yes for CLEAN REBUILD content (apps, configs). Gated extras are simply skipped on non-matching hardware.
Does it touch my browser passwords?	—	Never. Password migration is permanently blocked in every mode.

11 Best Practices

Six habits that make every rebuild smooth.

- ✓ **Default to CLEAN REBUILD.** It's the safest choice. Reach for other modes only with a clear reason.
- ✓ **Back up the bundle twice.** Keep two copies in two places before you wipe a machine.
- ✓ **Always preview with Dry Run.** It costs one click and shows you everything before anything changes.
- ✓ **Finish the VERIFY checklist.** It exists so that nothing is forgotten.
- ✓ **Protect your bundle.** It may contain SSH private keys. Store it like you'd store the keys.
- ✓ **Logs are your friend.** A long log isn't a sign of failure. Read the red rows and *fatal* entries only.

A

Safety Policy Summary

Enforced by the engine regardless of what the interface shows.

Action	Policy
Raw registry import / export	Never
Browser passwords and cookies	Never
Shell / context-menu handler migration	Never
Silent downloads	Never
Windows settings transfer	SAME-HARDWARE or CUSTOM, and hardware PASS only
DriverStore transfer	SAME-HARDWARE or CUSTOM, and hardware PASS, and explicit toggle
Dry Run default (GUI)	ON
Real Apply	Requires an explicit confirmation dialog

B

Command-Line Reference

Everything in the GUI is available headless.

Run these from the src folder.

```
# Capture, apply, verify
python gui_app.py --cli capture --bundle C:\MyBundle --mode CLEAN_REBUILD --dry-run
python gui_app.py --cli apply --bundle C:\MyBundle --mode CLEAN_REBUILD --dry-run
python gui_app.py --cli verify --bundle C:\MyBundle --mode CLEAN_REBUILD --dry-run
```

WARNING

In the command line, Dry Run is off unless you add --dry-run. This is different from the GUI, where it is on by default. Without the flag, the command makes real changes.

Options

Option	Effect
<code>--bundle PATH</code>	Bundle folder to use (required).
<code>--mode MODE</code>	CLEAN_REBUILD (default), SAME_HARDWARE_TRANSFER or CUSTOM.
<code>--dry-run</code>	Preview only; make no changes.
<code>--no-winget</code>	Turn Winget off (on by default).
<code>--choco / --scoop</code>	Turn Chocolatey or Scoop on (off by default).
<code>--no-git --no-gitconfig --no-ssh --no-vscode --no-terminal</code>	Turn individual developer configs off (all on by default).
<code>--tz-region / --power-plan</code>	Turn on the gated Windows settings (needs a non-CLEAN mode and hardware PASS).
<code>--no-driver-inventory / --no-driver-checklist</code>	Turn the safe driver options off.
<code>--driver-transfer</code>	Advanced: export/restore the DriverStore (gated).
<code>--validate-key KEY</code>	Check whether a license key is valid.

Exit codes

Code	Meaning
0	Success
1	Completed, but some items failed
2	Usage error (for example, a missing --bundle)



Printable Rebuild Checklist

Print this page and tick as you go.

Before reinstalling — on the old Windows

- ☐ WinGOES Pro and PyQt6 are installed and the app opens
- ☐ Mode chosen (CLEAN REBUILD unless I have a reason)
- ☐ Toggles chosen; bundle folder is on a drive that will **not** be wiped
- ☐ Ran ► **Capture** with Dry Run **OFF** and saw ✓ COMPLETED
- ☐ Reviewed Step Results; nothing important failed
- ☐ Bundle copied to USB / external disk
- ☐ Second backup copy made somewhere else
- ☐ Own files (documents, photos) backed up separately

After reinstalling — on the fresh Windows

- ☐ Windows installed and updated
- ☐ Python 3.11+ installed; `pip install PyQt6` done
- ☐ WinGOES Pro and the bundle copied across
- ☐ Launched as administrator (badge shows ✓ Admin)
- ☐ Selected the bundle and the **same mode** as Capture
- ☐ Ran ► **Apply** with Dry Run **ON** and read the results
- ☐ Switched Dry Run **OFF**, ran ► **Apply**, confirmed the dialog
- ☐ Ran ► **Verify**
- ☐ Completed every item on the VERIFY checklist (GPU, chipset, vendor tools)
- ☐ Reinstalled any apps flagged as “not available from any source”
- ☐ Deleted or securely stored the bundle (it may contain SSH keys)

TIP

If you ever hesitate, choose CLEAN REBUILD. It is always safe, always supported, and never carries old problems forward.